ABOUT THIS PIECE

Lesson plan: swooping multisyllabic words

Katherine Conklin

WHAT IT IS

A 1-on-1 resource-room reading lesson for a 5th grader reading at a 2nd-grade level. The student decodes multisyllabic words by "swooping" syllables. Written for class and used with students.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Explicit instruction, guided practice, and accommodations in a short lesson.

Lesson plan: Swooping multisyllabic words

Closed syllables · Katherine Conklin

Grade level: 5th (reading at a 2nd-grade level) **Setting:** 1-on-1 resource room **Subject:** Reading and phonics **Duration:** 25–30 minutes

Focus

Using “swooping” to decode multisyllabic words with closed syllables.

Objective

The student will read multisyllabic words with closed syllables by identifying syllable breaks and swooping the chunks to blend the full word.

Warm-up (5 minutes)

Review CVC words. The student says each one and draws a “swoop” under the whole word.

Explicit instruction (5–7 minutes)

- Teach the VC/CV rule: if there are two consonants between vowels, split between them.
- Model “napkin”: nap | kin, draw the swoops, and blend aloud.

Guided practice (10 minutes)

The student will:

- Identify the vowels
- Split between the consonants
- Draw swoops under each syllable
- Blend and read the word aloud

Target words: napkin, cactus, dentist, sunset, muffin, picnic

Application (5–7 minutes)

Use a decodable or familiar short reading passage. The student highlights or swoops syllables in multisyllabic words and reads them aloud.

Wrap-up (3 minutes)

Ask, “How did swooping help you today?” and reinforce it as a decoding strategy.

Accommodations used

- Visual supports and color coding
- Repeated modeling
- Extra wait time
- Individual encouragement
- Manipulatives if needed